

To Whom It May Concern:

Please accept this letter expressing my interest in the position of Program Associate within the Local Journalists Initiative at the Council on Foreign Relations. I am eager to join the dedicated team in this office, and to be part of the collaborative and innovative organization that has stood as a pillar in producing insightful and indispensable news. Particularly, I am inspired by the initiative's mission of strengthening journalism by supporting reporters to connect the issues facing local communities with the larger national and international dynamics that shape them. With my legal administrative and legislative experience, as well as my work in local journalism, I am eager to contribute to the Local Journalists Initiative at the Council of Foreign Relations. It is through continued learning that we as a citizenry remain informed and apprised of the ongoing circumstances, and by doing so, protect democracy.

I graduated cum laude from the University of Massachusetts, Amherst, Commonwealth Honors College, with B.A. in Political Science, a minor in History, and an International Relations Certificate with a 3.94 overall GPA. Courses such as Introduction to Political Theory, Controversies in Public Policy, Public Opinions in Politics, Power, Media in American Politics, and Culture, Society, and People provided an opportunity to examine the process of policymaking and the nexus of politics with public opinion, as well as influential factors, for instance, media and other societal factors. Additionally, I conducted a thesis examining the political socialization and identity formation of second-generation immigrants, aiming to understand better how societal influences and pressures shape their role within the electorate. Studying political science has allowed me to access and address the political landscape by understanding power dynamics, stakeholders' rationale, and citizens' political knowledge.

Currently, I work as a copy editor and obituary writer for the Falmouth Publishing Company, Inc., which publishes the *OnCape* magazine and four editions of the *Enterprise: The Falmouth Enterprise, The Sandwich Enterprise, The Mashpee Enterprise and The Bourne Enterprise*. While operating under the deadline of publication, my responsibilities include, managing and delegating inquiries sent into the *Enterprise*, copy-editing press releases, articles and columns, and writing news obituaries. The collaborative environment of the newsroom allows for an opportunity to brainstorm, as well as the chance to work together to ensure that each issue is finalized.

Additionally, as an Administrative Assistant at Ament Klauer LLP, I collaborate with attorneys to draft, research, and file documents with regional town halls, registries of deeds, other law firms, and local businesses. I frequently use assessors' databases, registries of deeds, and GIS maps to build comprehensive client files. To maintain, manage, and track the legal files, I catalog and archive them both digitally and physically. Additionally, I respond to and assist with inquiries from both current and potential clients, attorneys representing the other side of the transaction, and other officials. This role has strengthened my skills in legal document preparation, effective communication with clients and supervisors, and records management.

Previously, as an intern in the Office of State Representative Dylan Fernandes of Barnstable, Dukes, and Nantucket, I attended caucus meetings and policy briefings, monitored news sources to compile relevant press clippings, and drafted 'Thank You' letters to recognize constituents' efforts. I researched clean energy alternatives, ocean acidification, childcare services on Cape Cod, and the COVID-19 pandemic's impact on economic inequity in the district. I also created informational factsheets and flyers through Canva to promote Representative Fernandes' legislation and events. This experience enhanced my ability to translate complex policy information into clear, accessible messages.

Upon completing my internship, I also had the opportunity to participate in the fundraising and canvassing for Representative Fernandes' successful state Senate campaign for Barnstable and Plymouth County. This involved fundraising, cold-calling, and door-knocking.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I greatly appreciate it. I am eager to work at the State House. Please feel free to contact me if you have any questions.

Sincerely,
Helen Sievert